

UNIT 6 / Food and shopping

At the café

Your goal: Order politely, understand a follow-up question and ask for the bill.

01 Learn the idea

Ich möchte is a useful polite request meaning I would like. Put the item after it: Ich möchte einen Kaffee, bitte. Kaffee is masculine, so it becomes einen Kaffee as the object. With water, say ein Wasser when ordering one serving; in other contexts Wasser can be uncountable.

The server may ask Sonst noch etwas? meaning anything else. Answer Ja, einen Tee, bitte or Nein, danke. Zum Mitnehmen means to take away, while hier means here. Die Rechnung, bitte asks for the bill. Read the order as a real exchange and practise responding rather than reciting a list.

Words and phrases

German	English
Ich möchte einen Kaffee, bitte.	I would like a coffee, please.
Sonst noch etwas?	Anything else?
Zum Mitnehmen, bitte.	To take away, please.
Nein, danke.	No, thank you.
Die Rechnung, bitte.	The bill, please.

Say each phrase aloud. Listen on the lesson page, then repeat without looking at the English.

02 Conversation and mission

Read the conversation once for meaning. Repeat both roles, then cover the English and perform it again.

Server

Was möchten Sie?

What would you like?

Mia

Einen Kaffee, bitte. Zum Mitnehmen.

A coffee, please. To take away.

Server

Sonst noch etwas?

Anything else?

Mia

Nein, danke.

No, thank you.

Your real-life mission

Role-play both customer and server. Order a drink, specify here or takeaway, answer Anything else? and ask for the bill.

Plan or write your response here. Try first; a model appears in the answer key.

03 Practice without peeking

Choose one answer per question. For the final question, return to the conversation. Mark difficult items and explain your choice before checking the key.

1. What does “Ich möchte einen Kaffee, bitte.” mean?

- A. Anything else?
- B. To take away, please.
- C. I would like a coffee, please.

2. What does “Sonst noch etwas?” mean?

- A. Anything else?
- B. To take away, please.
- C. No, thank you.

3. What does “Zum Mitnehmen, bitte.” mean?

- A. No, thank you.
- B. To take away, please.
- C. The bill, please.

4. Complete: Ich möchte ____ Kaffee.

- A. ein
- B. eine
- C. einen

5. Where will Mia drink her coffee?

- A. She orders it to take away
- B. At a table in the café
- C. The dialogue says at school

Reflection: Which phrase will you use this week?

04 Answer key and review

1. C - I would like a coffee, please.

“Ich möchte einen Kaffee, bitte.” means “I would like a coffee, please.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

2. A - Anything else?

“Sonst noch etwas?” means “Anything else?”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

3. B - To take away, please.

“Zum Mitnehmen, bitte.” means “To take away, please.”. Read the example aloud, then use it in your own sentence.

4. C - einen

Kaffee is masculine and is the object of möchte, so use einen.

5. A - She orders it to take away

Zum Mitnehmen specifies takeaway, without saying the final location.

One possible mission response

Ich möchte einen Kaffee, bitte. Zum Mitnehmen. Nein, danke. Die Rechnung, bitte.

Your own answer can differ. Check whether it completes the task and uses the lesson's patterns.

Build the habit

Today: say five phrases aloud. Tomorrow: cover the answers and try the quiz again. In one week: repeat the conversation with your own details.

Continue learning

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